THE RESTLESS FOUNDER / FREE GUIDE

The Done List

A three-minute AI routine for founders who always feel behind, even when they are not.

Your finish line keeps moving. This is the scoreboard that doesn't.

You are measuring against a finish line that moves.

High performers keep raising the bar. Every time you reach a goal, the next one appears a little further out, so the sense of having arrived never comes.

That is not a flaw. It is what drives the work in the first place. But it has a side effect: your brain only ever sees the distance left, and never the distance covered. When you run several things at once, the list of what is still open is always longer than the list of what is done, so you feel behind on a day when you moved a great deal.

The problem

Open loops are loud. Finished work is silent. Your memory keeps the first and drops the second.

The fix

Give the finished work a place to live, and let AI keep it for you, so you can see it whenever the feeling arrives.

You are rarely as far behind as it feels.

Keep the list.

At the end of the working day, talk for a minute about what actually got finished. Let AI write it down and keep the running total.

1 **Open one conversation and keep it.** Call it The Done List. Use the same one every day so it holds the whole record.

2 **Ramble what got done.** Big or small. Sent an email, fixed a page, made a decision. Voice dictation is fine and mess is fine.

3 **Let it log and add it up.** You get back a clean list and a running count for the week. You do nothing else.

START THE LIST (PASTE ONCE)

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This conversation is my Done List. Every evening I will tell you, in
a ramble, what I finished that day. Turn it into a short list of
finished things, one line each, starting with a past tense verb. Add
it to the running list for this week and tell me the total. Only
include what I actually say I finished. Do not give me advice unless
I ask.
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Look at how far you have come.

The daily list is the record. The Friday review is where it changes how you feel.

FRIDAY REVIEW

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Here is my Done List for the week. Give me: the five things that
moved the business forward most, anything I finished that I have
probably forgotten about, what took longer than it should have, and
one thing I can stop doing. Then tell me, in two sentences, honestly,
how this week compares with a typical one. Be direct and be kind.
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Then set the line, on purpose

Before the next week starts, choose the finish line yourself, and keep it fixed until Friday. A line that only moves once a week is a line you can actually reach.

SET THE FINISH LINE

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Based on this week's Done List and what is still open: [paste or
describe]. Suggest three outcomes for next week that I can
realistically finish, each in one sentence, each something I can tick
off. Tell me what to leave out so I do not overload myself.
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When you feel behind anyway.

BEHIND COMPARED TO WHAT

I feel behind. Here is my Done List for the last thirty days: [paste]. Compare what is on it with what I said I wanted to do. Show me where I am genuinely on track and where I have actually slipped. Do not reassure me, just show me the evidence.

THE RESET

I am overwhelmed. Here is everything open: [paste]. Pick the one thing that, if I finish it, makes the rest easier. Give me the first step in one sentence, five minutes or less. Put everything else on hold until I come back.

THE THANK-YOU NOTE

Read my Done List for the month and write me a short note, five sentences at most, saying what I have built and what I should be proud of. Make it specific. Nothing generic.

Three things, in order.

1 **Tonight:** paste the Start the list prompt and ramble what you finished today. Two minutes.

2 **Every evening this week:** add to it. If you miss a day, ramble two days. Do not catch up, just continue.

3 **Friday:** run the review, set the finish line for next week, and leave it where it is.

That is the whole routine. It takes about three minutes a day, and by the end of the month you will be holding a list of what you did, in your own words, written by the one person who was there.

Not financial or medical advice. A working routine to adapt: change the words until they sound like you.

Feeling behind is a sign you care about the work. It is not a measurement.